INCH-POUND

MIL-DTL-12718G
5 February 2024
SUPERSEDING
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30 September 1985

DETAIL SPECIFICATION

INSIGNIA, DISTINGUISHING, U.S. ARMY, U.S. AIR FORCE, U.S. MARINE CORPS AND U.S. SPACE FORCE EMBROIDERED

This specification is approved for use by all
Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers distinguishing insignia for the U.S. Army, U.S. Air Force, U.S. Marine Corps and U.S. Space Force.

1.2 Classification. Distinguishing insignia will be of the following types as specified (see 6.2).

Type I - U.S. Army
Type II – U.S. Air Force
Type III - U.S. Marine Corps Woodland Camouflage (MARPAT)
Type III - U.S. Marine Corps Special Character Woodland Camouflage MARPAT)
Type IIIA - U.S. Marine Corps Desert Camouflage (MARPAT)
Type IIIA - U.S. Marine Corps Special Character Desert Camouflage (MARPAT)
Type IV - U.S. Space Force

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to The Institute of Heraldry, ATTN: Technical and Production Division, 9325 Gunston Road, Room S-108, Fort Belvoir, VA 22060-5579 or email to usarmy.belvoir.hqda.mil.tioh-webmaster@mail.mil. You may verify the currency of this specification using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

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2.2.1 Specification, standards and handbooks. The following specifications, standards and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents cited in the solicitation or contract.

FEDERAL SPECIFICATIONS

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup

COMMECIAL

A-A-50199 - Thread, Polyester core, Cotton-or polyester Covered.

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATIONS

MIL-DTL-44436 – Cloth, Wind Resistant Poplin, Nylon/Cotton Blend

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENCE STANDARDS

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-1916 - DoD Preferred Methods for Acceptance of Product
MIL-STD-2073-1 – Standard Practice for Military Packaging

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil)).

2.2.2 Other Government document drawings and Publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY (TIOH) DRAWINGS

A-1-241 - U.S. Army Distinguishing Insignia
A-1-790 - U.S. Air Force Distinguishing Insignia
A-1-792 - U.S. Marines Distinguishing Insignia
A-1-792A - U.S. Marines Special Character
A-1-1138 - U.S. Space Force Distinguishing Insignia

US MARINE CORPS DOCUMENT
MIL-PRF-MCCUU - Uniform, Combat/Utility, Camouflage Pattern, Marine Corps

(Copies of standards, drawings and Chip sets are available from The Institute of Heraldry, ATTN: Technical and Production Division, 9325 Gunston Road, Room S-108, Fort Belvoir, VA 22060-5579 or usarmy.belvoir.hqda.mi.tioh-webmaster@mail.mil.)

(Figures 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5 are miniature reproductions of the referenced drawings and are attached for information only.)

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2.3 Non-government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issue of the documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE STANDARD SHADES FOR HERALDIC YARNS
FOR EMBROIDERY AND RIBBONS, 2012 EDITION

(Copies for this document are available online at www.salesRA@amefird.com).

THE COLOR ASSOCIATION OF THE UNITED STATES
The Standard Color Reference of America, Tenth Edition
United States Army Color Card, The official Colors for Branches, Agencies, etc.

(Copies for this document are available online at https// www.colorassociation.com)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

ASTM - D3951 - Packaging, Commercial

ASTM - D5118/D5118M - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

(Copies for these documents are available online at https://www.astm.org)

2.3 Order of precedence. Unless otherwise noted herein or in the contract, in the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection in accordance with 4.3.

3.2 Materials. Materials shall conform to the referenced specifications and the requirements specified herein.

3.3 Design. The distinguishing insignia shall conform to TIOH drawings A-1-241; A-1-792; A-1-792A, A-1-790 and A-1-1138.

3.4 Base Cloth.

3.4.1 Base Cloth for Types I, II and IV. Types I, II and IV distinguishing tapes will be embroidered on Class 15, Three Color Insignia Pattern base cloth identified in MIL-DTL-44436. Figures 1, 2, and 5 provide information for embroidery on base cloth.

a. Type I will be embroidered with Black yarn, Cable Number 67138.

b. Type II will be embroidered with Spicebrown yarn, Cable Number 67196.

c. Type IV will be embroidered with Space Blue yarn, Cable Number 67207.

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3.4.2 Base Cloth for Types III and IIIA. Types III and IIIA distinguishing tapes will be embroidered on base cloth identified in MIL-PRF-MCCUU. Figure 3 and 4 provides information for embroidery on base cloth.

a. Type III will be embroidered on Type I, Class 4 Woodland MARPAT Camouflage Printed base cloth identified with Black thread, Cable Number 67138.

b. Type IIIA will be embroidered on Type II, Class 3 Desert MARPAT Camouflage Printed base cloth identified with Marine Corps Olive Drab, Cable Number 67205.

3.4.3 Colorfastness. When tested as specified in 4.3.3, the colorfastness of the finished insignia for wet-dry cleaning, bleaching, laundering, and light shall be equal to, or better than, the colorfastness of the guide sample. When no guide sample is furnished, the colorfastness to wet-dry cleaning, bleaching, laundering, and light shall be good.

3.4.4 Color Matching. The color shall match the approved standard shade (from the DOD Standard Shades for Heraldic Yarns for Embroidery and Ribbons, 2012 Edition; see 2.2) under natural (North Sky) daylight or artificial daylight having a color temperature of 7500° ± 500° Kelvin. The color shall also be a good approximation to the standard shade under incandescent lamplight at 2800° ± 100° Kelvin.

3.5. Embroidery thread.

a. The needle thread shall be either a cotton wrap, polycore, Type I, Ticket 50, 2-ply, conforming to A-A-50199 (see 6.5) polyneon no. 40. The bobbin thread shall be either a cotton wrap, polycore Type I, Ticket 50, 2-ply conforming to A-A-50199 or a 100% nylon Type I, Class A, 210 denier (70, 3-ply) conforming to V-T-295.

b. For Type III and IIIA insignia, the color of the needle thread shall conform to Black Cable No. 67138 (see the DOD Standard Shades For Heraldic Yarns For Embroidery and Ribbons, 1993 Edition referenced in 2.2). For Type IIIB and IIIC insignia, the color of the needle thread shall conform to Brown Cable No. 67136. 40 thread is used. The color of the bobbin thread shall match the needle thread if cotton wrap polycore is used for the bobbin thread. If nylon bobbin thread is used, the color shall be black.

3.6 Construction of Types I, II, III, IIIA, and IV. These insignia shall be fabricated in accordance with the details and dimensions shown on Figures 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5 as applicable.

3.6.1 Physical requirements. Each insignia shall conform to the physical requirements listed in the TIOH drawings.

3.6.2 Base fabric tape. The length of cloth for the tapes shall be cut in the filling direction, i.e., from selvage to selvage. The cut width of the tape shall be 2 inches ± 1/8 inch. Top and bottom edges of the tape cloth shall be folded under 1/2 inch toward the center back. A 1 inch wide strip of washable fusible interlining shall be centered and fused to the underside of the cut tape. The finished width of the tape prior to embroidery shall be 1 inch + 1/16 inch - 0.)

3.6.3 Workmanship. The finished insignia shall be clean, well-made and shall meet the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) established by this specification.

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4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Inspection responsibility. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 First Article. Unless otherwise specified, inspection and testing of the first article shall be made on completely fabricated insignia for all provisions of this specification applicable to the end item product examination and test.

4.3 Inspection for acceptance. Inspection for acceptance shall be in accordance with the provisions of MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise.

4.3.1 Testing of component. In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications and drawings, inspection shall be performed on the yarn for the characteristics shown. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one pound and the unit of the product shall be one holder. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more units fail to meet any requirement referenced in Table II. The sample size shall be as follows:

Lot size	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000	3
Over 22,000	5

When the data in the “determine per unit of product” and “results reported as” columns are not specified in Table II, they shall be required by the referenced test method.

TABLE II. **Component testing.**

CHARACTERISTIC	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	TEST METHOD	# DETERM PER UNIT OF PRODUCT	RESULTS REPORTED AS
Types I, IA, II, IIA, IV, & IVA				
Material identification	3.3.1.1	1600*	---	pass or fail
Denier	3.3.1.1	4021*	----	----
Color	3.3.1.2	visual	1	pass or fail
Labile sulfur	3.3.1.2	2020	1	pass or fail
Types III & IIIA				
Material identification	3.3.2.2.1	2530*	----	pass or fail
Color	3.3.2.2.2	visual	1	pass or fail

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* Unless otherwise specified, a contractor's certification of compliance may be accepted as evidence of conformance.

4.3.2 Inspection of the item.

4.3.2.1 Visual examination. Defects found during the examination shall be scored in accordance with Table III. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one insignia. The unit of product shall be one insignia. The sample size shall be in accordance with inspection level II and AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. **Classification of defects.**

Examine	Defects
Design	Any detail not as specified on figures 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5 as applicable.
Material	Hole, float, broken end, slub, streak or running defect in material.
	Broken, cut or torn selvage edge.
Workmanship	Cut, tear or abrasion.
	Misshaped or distorted design.
	Lettering improperly centered between selvage and ends.
	Background showing through lettering.
	Permanent crease.
	Insignia askew.
	Weave variation (cutting mark) larger than 3/8 inch in filling direction and 1/8 inch in warp direction not centered between beginning and ending of patterns.
	Spot, stain, or foreign matter on face.
Finish	Not correct color or shade as specified.
	Back not finish.
Heat sealing	Excessive unsealed fibers on ends (except at cutting marks).
	Face yarn discolored (due to heat sealing.

4.3.2.2 Dimensional examination. Measurement defect shall be scored in accordance with Table IV. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one insignia. The unit of product shall be one insignia. The sample size shall be in accordance with level S-3 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE IV. **Classification of dimensional defects**

Examine	Defects
Height of letters	More than 25/32 inch or less than 23/32 inch.
Thickness of letters	Variation of more than 1/64 inch from requirement.
Overall length	Variation greater than authorized tolerance.
Overall width	Variation greater than authorized tolerance.

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4.3.2.3 Examination for count. The following shall govern this examination:

Examination	Lot expressed In units of	Units of product	No. of units	Sample size No. of units
a. # insignia per folding or set up box	One of folding or set up box	One of folding or set up box	Up to 300 301 or over	4 5
b. # folding or set up boxes per shipping container	One shipping container	One shipping container	Up to 3 4 to 6 7 and over	All 3 4

The lot shall be unacceptable if any of the following:

(a) Incorrect number of insignia per folding or set up box.

(1) The average number of insignia per box in sample is less than specified or the Quantity marked on the box.

(2) The number of the insignia in any box is more than 5 percent under the quantity Specified or the quantity marked on the box.

(b) Number of insignia per shipping container actual number of insignia per container Is less than specified, or less than quantity marked on container.

4.3.3 Testing of end item. When the data in "# determine per individual unit of product" and "results reported as" columns are not specified in Table V, they shall be as required by the reference test method. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one insignia. The unit of product shall be 8 inches, for color, texture, colorfastness and weave tests. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more units fail to meet the requirements referenced in Table V. The sample size shall be as follows.

Lot size	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000	3
Over 22,000	5

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TABLE V. **Testing of end item**

Characteristic	Requirement reference	Test method	# determine per individual unit of product	Results reported as
Weave	3.4.2	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Texture ends (total)	Table I	5050	1	Pass or fail
Ground	Table I	5050	1	Pass or fail
Letters	3.4.2	5050	1	Pass or fail
Selvage	Table I	5050	-	-
Picks per inch				
Colorfastness and reaction of finish to:				
Wet-dry cleaning	3.3.1.3	5622 1/	-	-
Laundering	3.3.1.3	5614 1/	-	-
Bleaching	3.3.1.3	5600 1/	-	-
Light	3.3.1.3	5600 1/	-	-
Stiffness	3.4.4	5206	1	Pass or fail

1/ When no guide sample is furnished, results shall be reported as good, fair or poor. Also, test reports will be furnished for the initial inspection lot. A certificate of compliance will be accepted for each color of each subsequent lot on the same contract, provided the manufacturer certifies that the dyer or dye formulation has not been changed.

4.3.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored I accordance with items listed below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packed, selected just prior to the closing operation. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.4 End item testing.

4.4.1 Test for fused ends. The insignia shall be firmly grasped on each side of the fused end with thumb and forefinger and a 25 pound pull applied across the fused end. This pull test shall be performed on both ends of the insignia and the insignia shall be examined to determine compliance with 3.5.3.

5 PACKING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When actual packaging of materiel is to be performed by DOD personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain requisite packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are

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maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activity within the Military Department or Defense Agency, or within the Military Department's System Command. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6 NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Insignia covered by this specification are intended to be worn on certain uniforms to designate the wearer is a member of the United States Army or United States Air Force as applicable to U.S. Army, U.S. Air Force, U.S. Marine Corps and U.S. Navy as applicable.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type and size required (see 1.2).
(c) When a guide sample will not be furnished (see 3.1).
(d) When a first article is not required (see 3.2).
(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (5.1).

6.3 Samples. For access to samples address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 First article. First article samples will be inspected and approved under the appropriated provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample or initial production item. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing

Bleaching
Embroidery, thread
Laundering
Selvage
Stiffness

6.6 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

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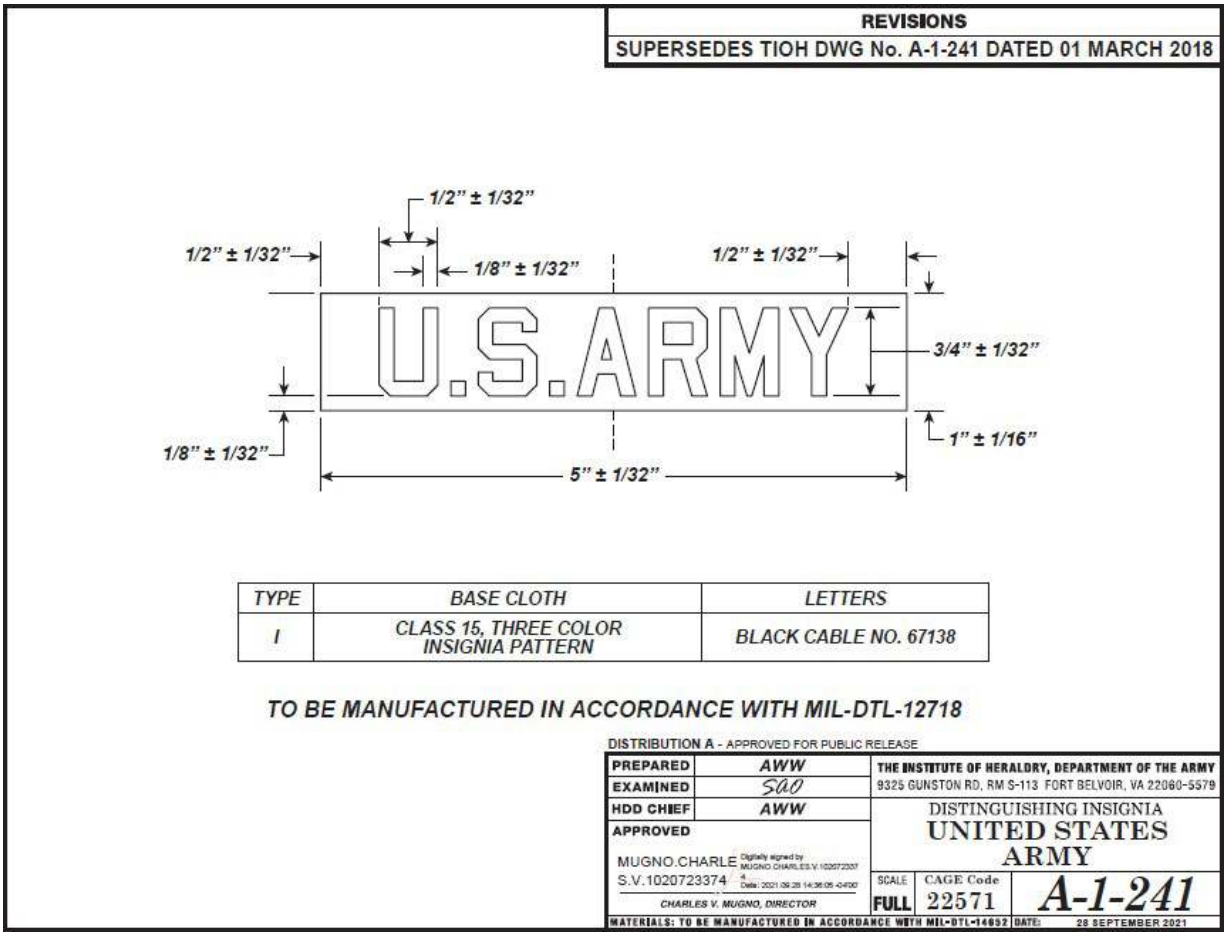


Figure 1. **U.S. ARMY Distinguishing Insignia**

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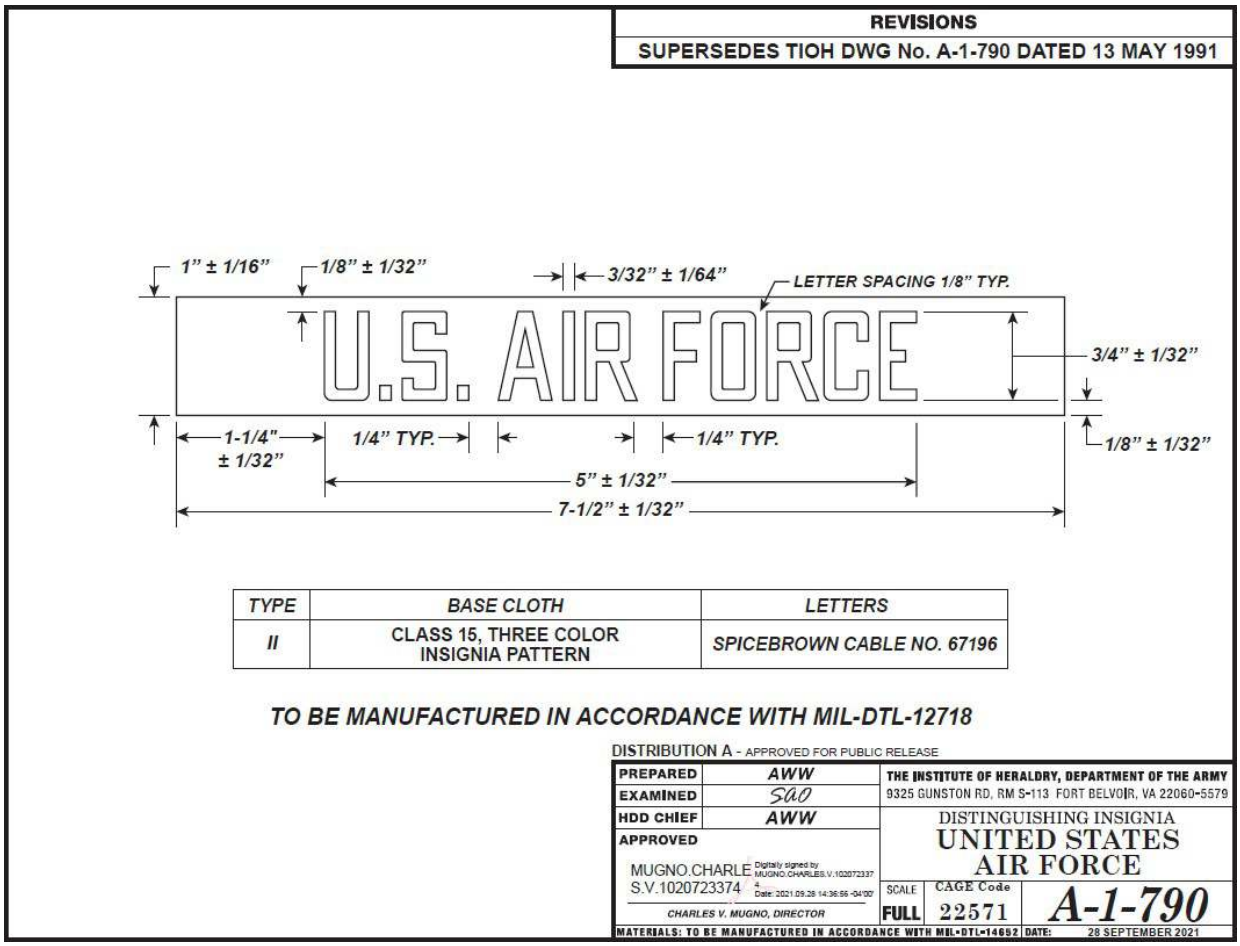


Figure 2. **U.S. AIR FORCE Distinguishing Insignia**

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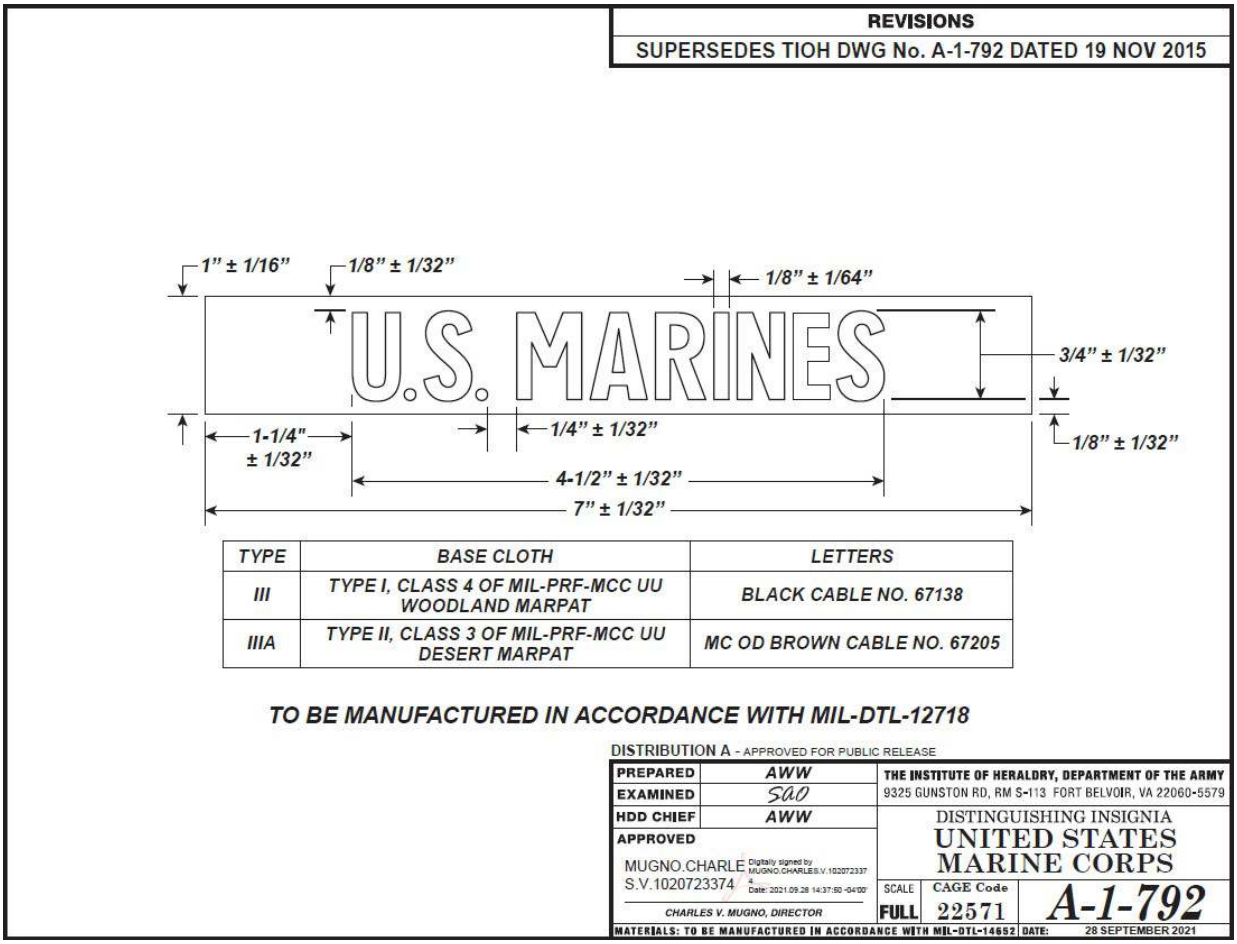


Figure 3. **U.S. MARINES Distinguishing Insignia**

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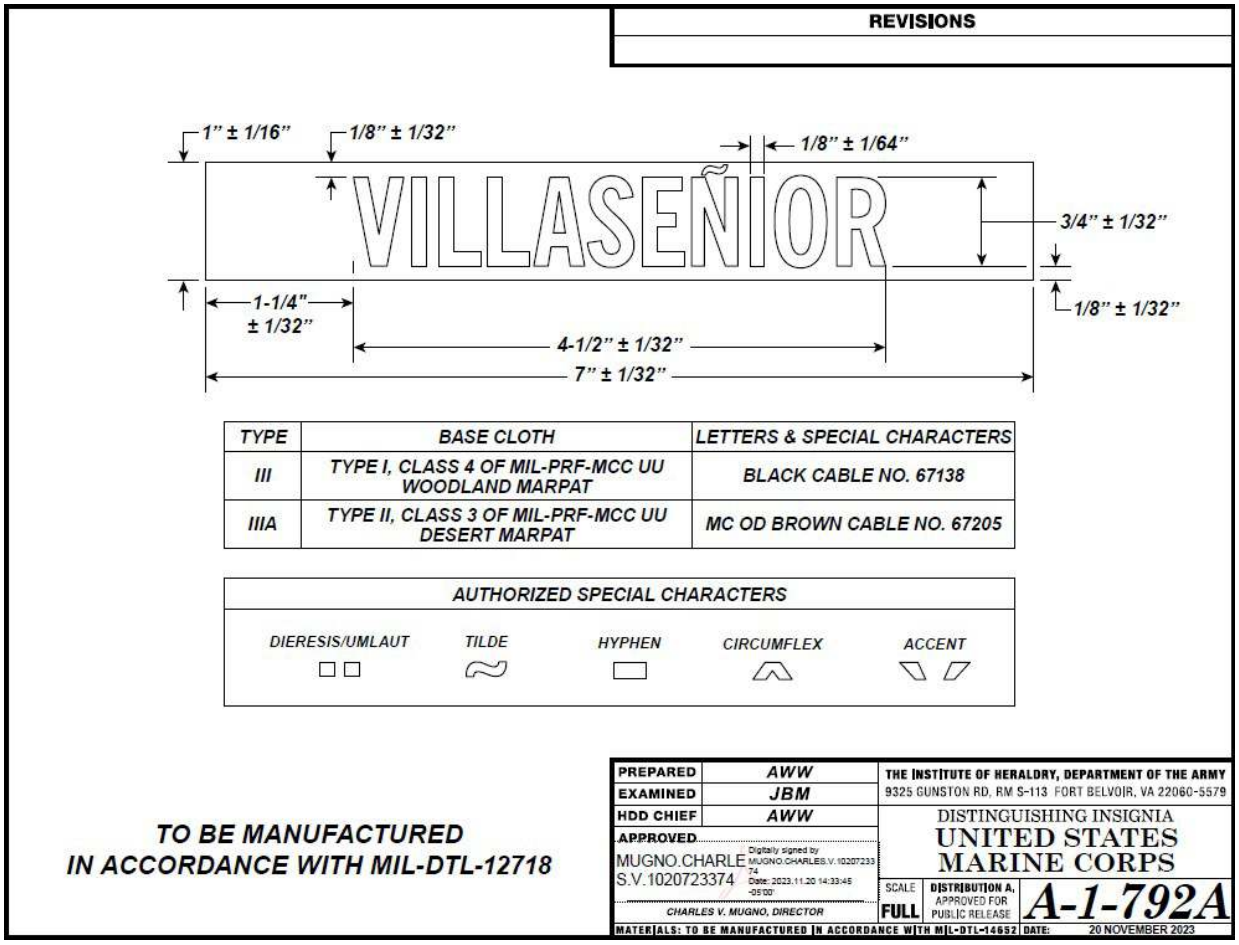


Figure 4. **U.S. MARINES Special Characters**

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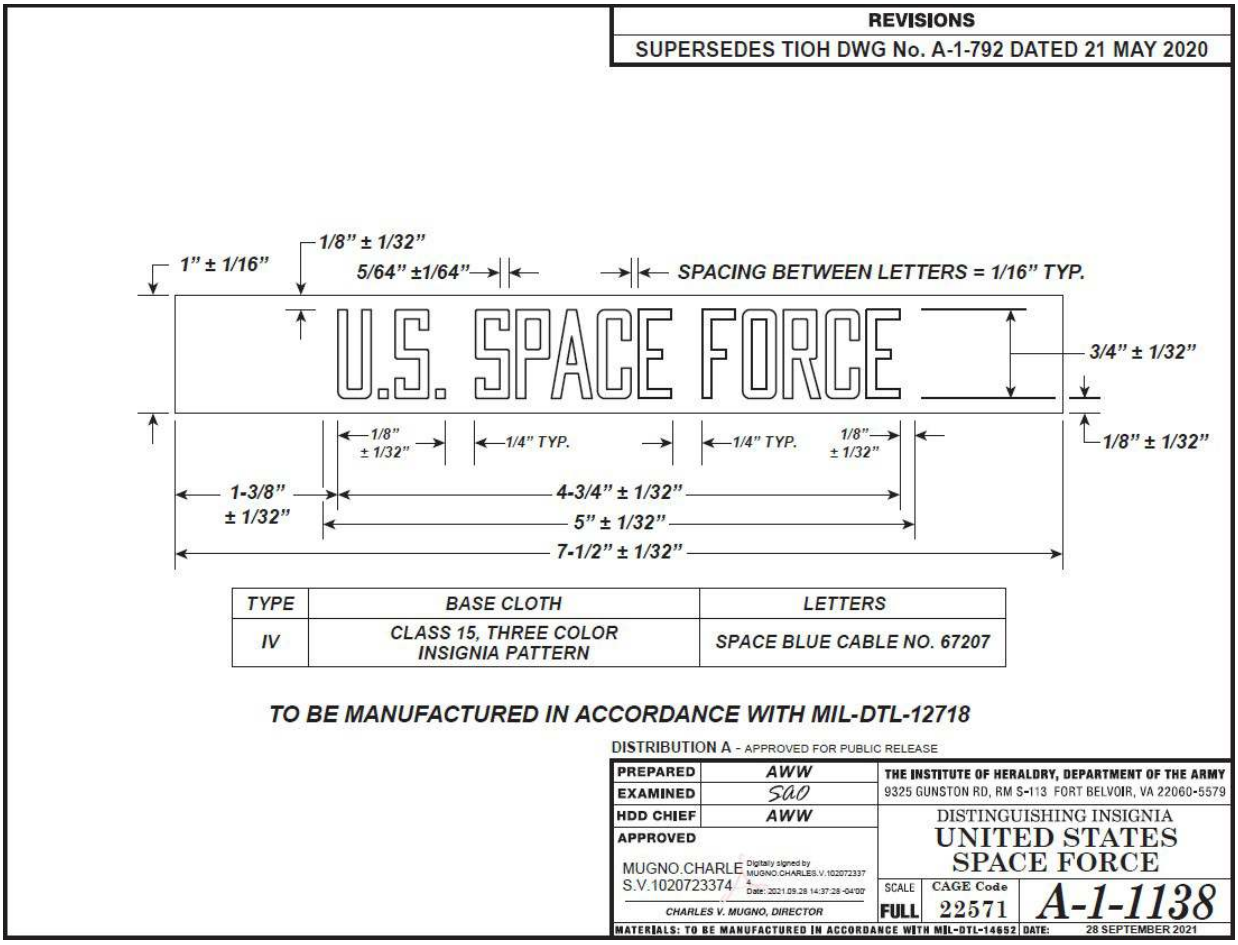


Figure 5. **U.S. SPACE FORCE Distinguishing Insignia**

Custodians:
Army - IH
Navy - NU
Air Force - 11

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

Review activities:
Navy - MC, CG1
DLA - CT

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